READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.*

The Origins of Weather Forecasting

The world's first public weather forecast appeared in The Times newspaper over 150 years ago: the beginning of a service that gives everyone something to comment on

The pioneering forecast on August 1, 1861, was introduced with a deceptively simple heading: 'General weather probable during next two days.' But those few words started an ongoing controversy that still continues today - after all, everyone remembers the forecasts that go wrong, but rarely the ones that are right.

The first forecast was the idea of Admiral Robert FitzRoy, head of the newly founded Meteorological Department, and one of Britain's greatest but least-known heroes. It was a brave undertaking, because in those days predicting the weather had gained a reputation similar to astrology or fortune-telling. The few people who attempted it had become a national joke when their forecasts inevitably went wrong.

FitzRoy was different, though. His background was faultless, most famously his captaining of the ship HMS Beagle on Charles Darwin's voyage around the world, which eventually led to the publication of Darwin's well-known book *On the Origin of Species*. When FitzRoy retired from active service as an admiral in Britain's navy, he was looking for a new direction. He subsequently secured a job as chief statistician at the Meteorological Department, part of the Board of Trade. Parliament had voted to set up and fund the Meteorological Department on June 30, 1854, to chart the safest sailing routes across the Atlantic Ocean. However, the British Government was not impressed with the idea of collecting weather reports and establishing a weather forecast, and the suggestion by one Member of Parliament for this was met with laughter from the other MPs.

FitzRoy was given a staff of three clerks in a small office in London, but he soon grew bored with the tedium of transcribing thousands of ships' reports. Instead, he focused on a much more pressing issue - the huge loss of life at sea from storms. This problem came to a head in 1859, when gale-force winds sank the ship named *Royal Charter*, with the loss of 430 lives, within sight of the shore. Even in those days when ships regularly sank in storms, the loss of the *Royal Charter* was considered a national tragedy. FitzRoy stirred up feelings even further when he wrote a letter to *The Times* newspaper explaining that the storm had been entirely predictable.

That same year, a total of 1,645 lives were lost off the British coast, and FitzRoy wrote repeatedly to *The Times* pushing for a storm-warning service for shipping. This was just the right moment for a national forecasting service. Knowledge of the weather was improving, barometer readings gave warning of approaching storms, and the invention of the electric telegraph and Morse code in 1844 gave instant communication for the first time.

So in February 1861, FitzRoy pressed ahead with a storm-warning service. Previously, weather reports had been unreliable, but FitzRoy's innovation was to issue ships with standardised instruments which allowed for accurate weather reports. At exactly the same time each day the information was sent to him by telegraph, and he was able to draw up more detailed weather maps. The approach of an incoming storm could be recognised, and from London, FitzRoy could telegraph warnings to ports on the coast, where an ingenious system of flags was hoisted up high for passing ships to read. This represented the biggest advance in shipping safety after the introduction of the lifeboat, and in subsequent years the number of lives lost around Britain fell by about a third. FitzRoy became a hero to the fishing and maritime fleets.

Encouraged by his storm-warning success, FitzRoy then started a public weather forecasting service. As he had a close connection with *The Times*, this newspaper introduced his daily forecast in August 1861. It attracted huge attention, including from Queen Victoria, who regularly sent messengers to FitzRoy's office to get a forecast for the sea crossing over the Solent to an island which she liked to visit off the south coast of England. He was also popular with ordinary fishermen, who were happy not to be out at sea in bad weather. The owners of fishing vessels, however, were not supportive of FitzRoy's forecasts, which often caused delays for them when bad weather was forecast.

Nevertheless, weather forecasting at that time was very difficult, and one mistake could result in much bad publicity. It wasn't long before some forecasts turned out wrong, and the letters pages of *The Times* were full of heated correspondence. It is indisputable that FitzRoy was way ahead of his time, but it is only in recent years that he has been recognised as a towering figure in meteorology, with the honour of an area of sea being given his name in the shipping forecast (a radio broadcast of weather reports for the seas around Britain). His extraordinary determination to get forecasting established cost him dearly though, and he died prematurely. But his legacy lives on, because late in his life he published a book about weather forecasting which was recognised by other scientists to be well ahead of its time.

Questions 1–5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 1–5 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE	*if the statement agrees with the information*
FALSE	*if the statement contradicts the information*
NOT GIVEN	*if there is no information on this*

1 In Robert FitzRoy's time, weather forecasting was a respected skill.

2 When FitzRoy retired from the navy, he had already had a successful career at sea.

3 FitzRoy faced competition from other applicants for the chief statistician's job.

4 The British Parliament supported the idea of regular weather forecasts in 1854.

5 Progress in technology made it a good time for publicly available weather forecasting to begin.

Questions 6–13

Complete the notes below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 6–13 on your answer sheet.

February 1861: Storm warning service

- FitzRoy received weather reports produced by ships using reliable **6** ……
- simultaneous weather reports were taken daily
- storm warnings were telegraphed to **7** …… along the shore
- signals for ships were displayed using raised **8** ……
- the storm warning service was the greatest development in sea safety since the **9** …… was introduced

August 1861: Public weather forecasting service

- very popular in *The Times* newspaper
- frequently used by the English Queen for safe trips to a favourite **10** ……
- FitzRoy's forecasts were popular with fishermen but not with boat **11** ……
- in modern times FitzRoy's **12** …… is used for a marine area
- FitzRoy produced a **13** …… which was respected by the scientific community

题号	答案	题干翻译	定位原文	定位翻译	详细解析
1	**FALSE**	在 Robert FitzRoy 的时代，天气预报是一项受人尊敬的技能。	**Paragraph 2**：*in those days predicting the weather had gained a reputation similar to astrology or fortune-telling. The few people who attempted it had become a national joke when their forecasts inevitably went wrong.*	在那个时代，预测天气已经获得了一种类似占星术或算命的名声。少数尝试预测天气的人，在他们的预报不可避免地出错时，已经成了全国的笑柄。	题干说 **weather forecasting was a respected skill**，即“天气预报是一项受尊敬的技能”。但原文说它的名声类似 **astrology or fortune-telling**，并且从事者成了 **national joke**。这明显是负面评价，不是受尊敬。因此与原文矛盾，答案是 **FALSE**。
2	**TRUE**	当 FitzRoy 从海军退役时，他已经在海上拥有成功的职业生涯。	**Paragraph 3**：*His background was faultless, most famously his captaining of the ship HMS Beagle on Charles Darwin's voyage around the world... When FitzRoy retired from active service as an admiral in Britain's navy...*	他的履历无可挑剔，最著名的是他曾在达尔文环球航行期间担任“小猎犬号”船长……当 FitzRoy 以英国海军上将身份从现役退役时……	题干核心是 **had already had a successful career at sea**。原文中的 **His background was faultless** 表示“履历无可挑剔”，并举例说他担任过 HMS Beagle 的船长，后来以 **admiral** 身份退役。虽然原文没有直接说 successful career，但“faultless background + captain + admiral”可以支持“成功的海上职业生涯”。答案是 **TRUE**。
3	**NOT GIVEN**	FitzRoy 在申请首席统计员职位时面临其他申请者的竞争。	**Paragraph 3**：*He subsequently secured a job as chief statistician at the Meteorological Department...*	他随后获得了气象部门首席统计员的职位……	原文只说他 **secured a job**，也就是“获得了这份工作”。但是没有提到是否有其他申请人，也没有提到竞争、面试、选拔等信息。题干中的 **competition from other applicants** 属于原文未提及内容，因此答案是 **NOT GIVEN**。
4	**FALSE**	英国议会在1854年支持定期天气预报的想法。	**Paragraph 3**：*Parliament had voted to set up and fund the Meteorological Department on June 30, 1854, to chart the safest sailing routes across the Atlantic Ocean. However, the British Government was not impressed with the idea of collecting weather reports and establishing a weather forecast, and the suggestion by one Member of Parliament for this was met with laughter from the other MPs.*	议会在1854年6月30日投票成立并资助气象部门，目的是绘制横跨大西洋最安全的航行路线。然而，英国政府并不欣赏收集天气报告并建立天气预报的想法，一名议员提出这个建议时，遭到了其他议员的嘲笑。	题干说 **Parliament supported the idea of regular weather forecasts in 1854**。原文确实说议会支持成立气象部门，但目的不是天气预报，而是 **chart the safest sailing routes**，绘制安全航线。对于 **establishing a weather forecast**，政府并不感兴趣，而且议员提出该建议还被其他议员嘲笑。因此题干与原文相反，答案是 **FALSE**。
5	**TRUE**	技术进步使公开天气预报的开始成为一个好时机。	**Paragraph 5**：*This was just the right moment for a national forecasting service. Knowledge of the weather was improving, barometer readings gave warning of approaching storms, and the invention of the electric telegraph and Morse code in 1844 gave instant communication for the first time.*	这正是建立全国预报服务的合适时机。人们对天气的了解正在提高，气压计读数能够预警即将到来的风暴，而1844年电报和摩尔斯电码的发明首次带来了即时通信。	题干中的 **Progress in technology** 对应原文的 **barometer readings**、**electric telegraph and Morse code**。题干中的 **made it a good time** 对应 **This was just the right moment**。虽然原文说的是 national forecasting service，不是直接重复 publicly available weather forecasting，但文章后面 FitzRoy 正是在这个基础上发展公共天气预报服务。题干概括成立，答案是 **TRUE**。

6	**instruments**	FitzRoy 收到了由船只使用可靠的 _____ 生成的天气报告。	**Paragraph 6**：*FitzRoy's innovation was to issue ships with standardised instruments which allowed for accurate weather reports.*	FitzRoy 的创新是给船只配发标准化仪器，这些仪器能够产生准确的天气报告。	空格前是 **ships using reliable...**，原文对应 **ships with standardised instruments**。题目中的 reliable 对应原文的 standardised / accurate。答案只能填一个词，所以填 **instruments**。
7	**ports**	风暴警报被通过电报告知给沿岸的 _____。	**Paragraph 6**：*from London, FitzRoy could telegraph warnings to ports on the coast...*	FitzRoy 可以从伦敦把警报通过电报发送到沿海港口。	题干中的 **telegraphed to... along the shore** 对应原文 **telegraph warnings to ports on the coast**。along the shore 是 on the coast 的改写。答案是 **ports**。
8	**flags**	给船只看的信号通过升起的 _____ 展示出来。	**Paragraph 6**：*where an ingenious system of flags was hoisted up high for passing ships to read.*	在那里，一套巧妙的旗帜系统被高高升起，供经过的船只读取。	题干中的 **signals for ships were displayed using raised...** 对应原文 **system of flags was hoisted up high**。raised 对应 hoisted up high。答案是 **flags**。
9	**lifeboat**	风暴警报服务是自 _____ 被引入以来，海上安全方面最伟大的发展。	**Paragraph 6**：*This represented the biggest advance in shipping safety after the introduction of the lifeboat...*	这代表了自救生艇被引入以来，航运安全方面最大的进步。	题干中的 **greatest development in sea safety since... was introduced** 对应原文 **biggest advance in shipping safety after the introduction of the lifeboat**。答案是 **lifeboat**。
10	**island**	英国女王经常使用天气预报，以便安全前往一个喜爱的 _____。	**Paragraph 7**：*Queen Victoria... regularly sent messengers to FitzRoy's office to get a forecast for the sea crossing over the Solent to an island which she liked to visit off the south coast of England.*	维多利亚女王经常派信使到 FitzRoy 的办公室，为穿越索伦特海峡、前往英格兰南海岸外一个她喜欢去的岛屿获取天气预报。	题干中的 **English Queen** 指 Queen Victoria。**safe trips to a favourite...** 对应原文 **to get a forecast for the sea crossing... to an island which she liked to visit**。答案是 **island**。
11	**owners**	FitzRoy 的预报受渔民欢迎，但不受船只 _____ 欢迎。	**Paragraph 7**：*He was also popular with ordinary fishermen... The owners of fishing vessels, however, were not supportive of FitzRoy's forecasts...*	他也受到普通渔民欢迎……然而，渔船的船主并不支持 FitzRoy 的天气预报……	题干形成对比：popular with fishermen but not with boat... 原文对应 **ordinary fishermen** 和 **owners of fishing vessels**。boat owners = owners of fishing vessels。答案是 **owners**。
12	**name**	在现代，FitzRoy 的 _____ 被用于一个海洋区域。	**Paragraph 8**：*he has been recognised as a towering figure in meteorology, with the honour of an area of sea being given his name in the shipping forecast...*	他被认可为气象学中的杰出人物，并获得了一项荣誉：航运天气预报中的一片海域以他的名字命名。	题干中的 **is used for a marine area** 对应原文 **an area of sea being given his name**。marine area = area of sea。答案是 **name**。
13	**book**	FitzRoy 写了一本受到科学界尊重的 _____。	**Paragraph 8**：*late in his life he published a book about weather forecasting which was recognised by other scientists to be well ahead of its time.*	在晚年，他出版了一本关于天气预报的书，这本书被其他科学家认为远远领先于时代。	题干中的 **produced** 对应原文 **published**；**respected by the scientific community** 对应 **recognised by other scientists**。空格需要名词，答案是 **book**。